



Lesson 200: The Law of Total Tricks

1 CENTRAL FORMULA

TOTAL TRICKS = sum of total trumps
between the two partnerships

EXAMPLE: we have **8** trumps + they have **8** trumps = **16** total tricks
(divided between the two partnerships)

2 LEVEL OF SAFETY

TOTAL TRUMPS IN LINE	LEVEL OF SAFETY (SAFE TO BID)
8 trumps in line	LEVEL 2 (safe to bid at level 2)
9 trumps in line	LEVEL 3 (safe to bid at level 3)
10 trumps in line	LEVEL 4! (safe to bid at level 4!)

3 FLAT DISTRIBUTIONS



WARNING!

**5332, 4333 =
DISADVANTAGEOUS
DISTRIBUTIONS,
NEED CAUTION**

- Fewer tricks than the Law predicts.

4 BONUS



Singleton in
opponent's suit

= +1 extra trick



Double fit
(fit in two suits)

= +1 extra trick

5

NORTH

A K Q J 10 9 4 2
5 TRUMPS

WE HAVE 9 TRUMPS (NORTH-SOUTH)

WEST

THEY HAVE 7 TRUMPS (EAST-WEST)

EAST

A Q J 10 9 8 3 2
4 TRUMPS

SOUTH

LEVEL 3 SAFE!

6

SUMMARY



COUNT
the trumps.



CHECK
the distribution.



CHOOSE
the right
level!



**GOOD PLANNING
LEADS TO MORE
TRICKS!**



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Lesson 201: Evaluations - Longs and Shorts

FIT is not enough! **You need SIDE SHORTS or LONGS**



SHORTS

Singletons and voids = possibility of a **RUFF**



Singletons are communicated to the partner, who evaluates!



SIDE LONGS

5+ cards = **ESTABLISHMENT**



Long suits produce extra winners after drawing trumps

SINGLE-SUITERS



★ With **77+** cards in a suit: that suit **MUST** be trump, ignore the points!

★ With the eighth card: points no longer matter!



NEGATIVE DOUBLE

Don't hide a long suit behind the Negative Double!

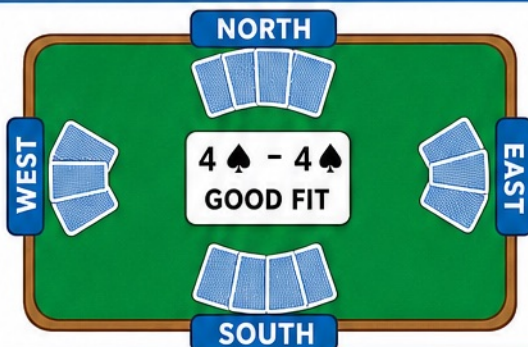


If you have 5+ cards in the suit, **BID** it directly

VISUAL EXAMPLE

♠ A K Q J
♥ 9 6 3 2
♦ K (singleton)
♣ A Q J 10 7

The singleton adds value!



MOTTO:

Fit + Short = Ruff.

Fit + Long = Extra tricks.

Fit alone = not enough!



LESSON 202: TEXAS TRANSFERS ON 1NT AND 2NT OPENING



1. TITLE: "TRANSFER (Jacoby):
transfer the play to your partner!"

2. MAIN TRANSFER SCHEME

2♦

I HAVE 5+ HEARTS

PARTNER
BIDS

2♥

2♥

I HAVE 5+ SPADES

PARTNER
BIDS

2♠

4. CONTINUATIONS AFTER THE TRANSFER

RESPONSE	MEANING	DETAILS
PASS	WEAK	0-7 HIGH CARD POINTS, PART SCORE
2NT	INVITATIONAL	8-9 HIGH CARD POINTS
3NT	GAME	10+ HIGH CARD POINTS, CHOICE BETWEEN 3NT AND 4 IN A MAJOR

3. SUPER ACCEPTANCE

PARTNER WITH
**FOUR-CARD FIT +
MAXIMUM** → JUMP TO
3 IN THE TRANSFER SUIT!

EXAMPLE:

1NT - 2♦ - 3♥!

(FOUR-CARD HEART FIT +
16-17 HIGH CARD POINTS)

5. MINOR SUIT TRANSFERS

2♠



I HAVE CLUBS

PARTNER BIDS
3♣

2NT



I HAVE DIAMONDS

PARTNER BIDS
3♦

6. SIX-STEP STAYMAN ON 1NT

1NT

1

2♦

PARTNER
BIDS
2♥

2

2♥

PARTNER
BIDS
2♠

3

2♠

PARTNER
BIDS
3♣

4

2NT

PARTNER
BIDS
3♦

5

3♣

PARTNER
BIDS
3♥

6

3♦

PARTNER
BIDS
3♠

1 2♦ = TRANSFER TO HEARTS

2 2♥ = TRANSFER TO SPADES

3 2♠ = TRANSFER TO CLUBS

4 2NT = TRANSFER TO DIAMONDS

5 3♣ = NATURAL, 6+ CLUBS

6 3♦ = NATURAL, 6+ DIAMONDS

REMEMBER!



**THE TRANSFER
LETS THE NT PLAYER
PLAY = PROTECTS
THEIR HONORS!**



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LESSON 203: DEVELOPMENTS AFTER 2 OVER 1 RESPONSES

1. MAIN RULE



2 over 1 = GAME FORCING
(with exceptions)



EXAMPLE: 1 SPADE - 2 CLUBS = PAIR COMMITTED TO GAME

2. OPENER'S REBIDS

2 DIAMONDS
= SIMPLE



2 HEARTS / 2 SPADES
= JUMP SHIFT



NT

2 NO TRUMP
= BALANCED
JUMP SHIFT



18-20 POINTS,
BALANCED



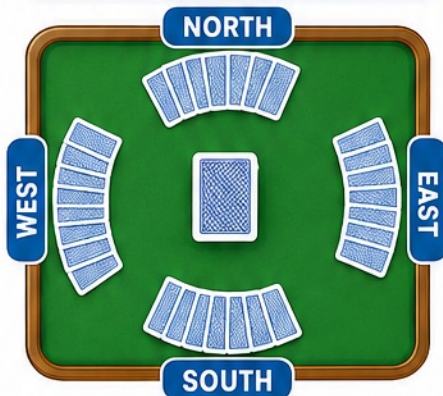
**3. RETURN TO 2
IN THE SUIT**

Returning to 2 in
partner's suit asks for
DESCRIPTION



Does **NOT** set the trump!
It's a **question**,
not an answer!

WEST	NORTH	EAST	SOUTH
1 ♠	PASS	2 ♣	?



4. RAISE TO 3



Raise to 3 in
the suit =

SLAM INTEREST
(15-16 POINTS)



Shows fit +
extra strength

**5. FOURTH SUIT
FORCING**



Bidding the 4th suit =

ASKS FOR A STOPPER
for No Trump



Does not promise
cards in the suit!

THE FOUR SUITS



SPADES

HEARTS

DIAMONDS

CLUBS



MOTTO:

**2 OVER 1: GAME IS GUARANTEED.
NOW FIND THE BEST CONTRACT!**



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SETTING THE TRUMP SUIT: the first step towards a Slam!

SOLID GROUND

21+ points in line



Setting BELOW game =
FORCING!
The partnership
MUST continue

Example:

1♠ - 2♣ - 3♠
= setting Spades, forcing

UNSOLID GROUND



Setting below game =
INVITATIONAL
(partner may pass!)

?

QUESTION 1:
Could partner
settle for
game?

?

QUESTION 2:
Were stronger
paths
available?

DELAYED FOURTH SUIT



Use the 4th suit to
CREATE solid ground
before setting

First establish strength,
then set!

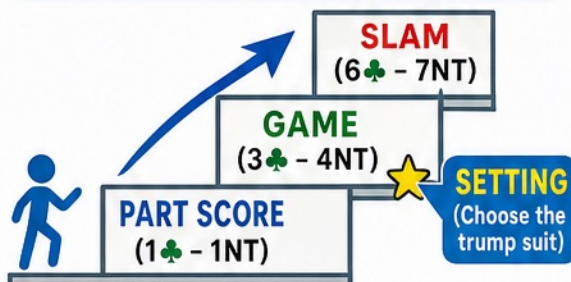
IN COMPETITION



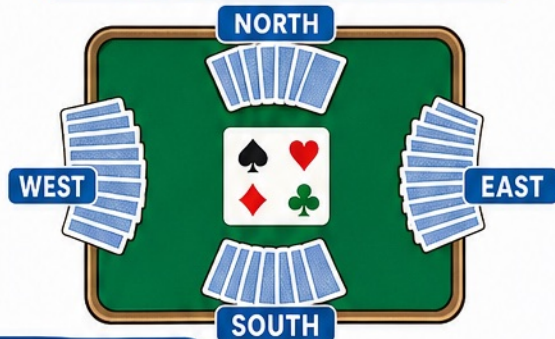
Setting in competition =
ONLY COMPETITIVE!

For the slam, use the
CUE BID
(cue bid of opponent's suit)

THE LADDER OF CONTRACTS



THE BRIDGE TABLE



REMEMBER:

Setting = agreement on the trump suit.
Solid ground = **obligation** to continue!

Lesson 205: Approaching Slam - Cue Bids



CUE BID: show your **CONTROLS to your partner!**



DEFINITION:

Cue bid = bidding a **CONTROL**
(Ace, void, King, singleton) in a side suit

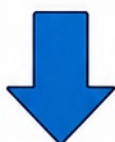
THE 4 RULES

1



DO NOT cue
in the trump suit!

2



Make the **LOWEST**
available cue bid

3



SKIPPED Cue =
that control is
MISSING!

4



Skipped cue
then made =
THIRD round control



Cue bids below game are MANDATORY!
DO NOT deny with a minimum hand -
only deny if you lack the control!

THE 4 PHASES OF SLAM

PHASE 1



SET
the trump suit

PHASE 2



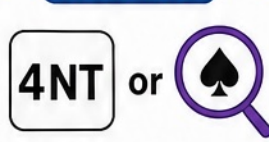
VERIFY
controls
(cue bid)

PHASE 3

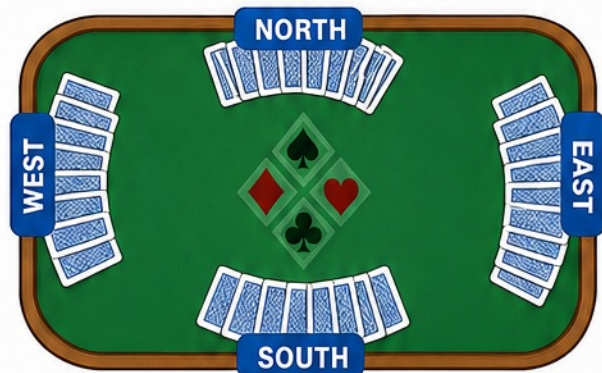


REDEFINE
strength

PHASE 4



4NT (Blackwood)
or final cue bid



GUARD LEVEL

Resting at the guard level =
MINIMUM.
Exceeding = **EXTRA** strength



MOTTO:

Cue bid = dialogue
about controls.
Every piece of information
counts for the slam!



FIGB

LESSON 206: WEAK TWO BIDS

1. TITLE: "WEAK TWO BIDS: 2D, 2H, 2S - PREEMPTIVE WITH 6 CARDS

2. REQUIREMENTS

- ✓ 6 cards in the suit
- ✓ 6-10 high card points
- ✓ 2 Diamonds: excellent suit, at least 2 **HIGH HONORS** (A, K, Q)

3. PROHIBITION



NEVER open a weak two with a side 4-card **MAJOR**!

EXAMPLE:

♦♦♦♦♦♦ + ♥♥♥♥

DO NOT open 2D, you risk missing the heart fit!

4. OGUST (2NT FROM RESPONDER)

3 ♣	MINIMUM + BAD suit
3 ♦	MINIMUM + GOOD suit
3 ♥	MAXIMUM + BAD suit
3 ♠	MAXIMUM + GOOD suit
3 NT	AKQxxx (very solid suit!)

5. RAISE TO 3



Raise to 3 in the suit = **SIGN OFF**

NOT an invitation! Partner **MUST** pass!

6. EXAMPLE HAND



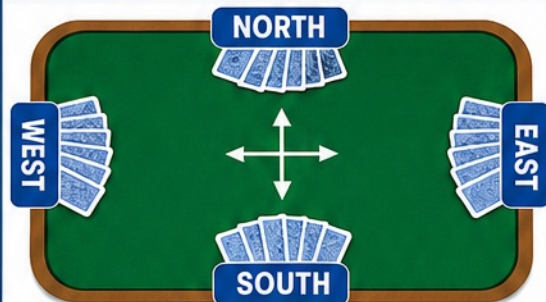
AKJ875

= 8 high card points

PERFECT FOR 2 SPADES!



BRIDGE TABLE: POSITIONS



7. MOTTO

The weak two bid steals space from opponents and describes a precise hand!

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FIGB

LESSON 207:

THE STRONG UNDETERMINED 2C OPENING

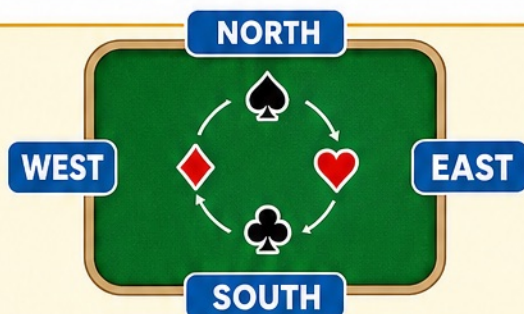


2 CLUBS: the only **STRONG** opening!
No upper limit!



CONCEPT

- 2C = very strong hand, at least **22-23+** points or **self-sufficient** play
- It is the **ONLY** strong opening in the system



RESPONSES TO 2C

2 DIAMONDS



"WAITING"
the most common response, says nothing about the hand

2 HEARTS / 2 SPADES



5+ cards with at least 1 honor + 5 points

GAME FORCING!



With a strong hand:
do not bid 2D, show your suit immediately!

OPENER'S REBIDS

2NT	balanced 23+ points	
2H / 2S	NOT game forcing up to 3 in the suit	
3H / 3S	CLOSED ONE-SUITER, sets the trump!	



BOARD CONTROL

On opponent's intervention:

EITHER WE PLAY, OR WE DOUBLE!

The 2C is so strong that opponents cannot play comfortably.



EXAMPLE



MOTTO



2 Clubs =
the atomic bomb of bidding.
Use it with respect!

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Lesson 208:

Competitive, Constructive, Preemptive

1. TITLE: THREE TYPES OF BIDDING: RECOGNIZE THEM!

COMPETITIVE



- Without game ambitions
- Suits to play, NOT jump bids
- Only to compete on the part score

CONSTRUCTIVE



- Serious attempt for game or slam
- Informative double / Cue bid / Forcing suit change
- Invites partner to evaluate

PREEMPTIVE



- Many tricks on offense + few on defense
- ALWAYS jump bids!
- Takes away opponents' bidding space

2. HOW TO RECOGNIZE THEM



1



Look at the **SYSTEM** (conventions)

2



Look at the **STRONG ALTERNATIVES** available

3



Look at the **INTENTION** already shown

3. GOLDEN PREEMPTIVE RULE



Make the preemptive bid at the **HIGHEST LEVEL** at the **FIRST OPPORTUNITY!**

Don't wait: the second round is too late!

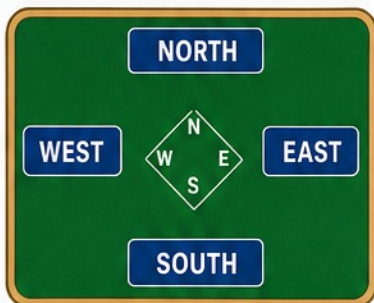


4. EXAMPLE: WITH 7 CARDS AND 5 POINTS ON THE FIRST ROUND

Holding (7 cards, 5 points):



5 HCP



First round:

SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
3♥	—	—	—

3 in the suit **IMMEDIATELY!**



Competitive = defend



Constructive = propose



Preemptive = attack!





FIT in the Major:

how to communicate strength with support

1 SUPPORT BARRAGE TABLE

Support at 3 → FOURTH fit with 0-7 points (barrage) **3** ♥

Support at 4 → FIFTH fit with 0-7 points (shutout barrage) **4** ♥



Objective: take away space from opponents!

★ 2 2NT TRUSCOTT

2NT

2NT = THIRD or FOURTH fit + game invitation (10-12 points)



NOT no-trump!
It's conventional!

3 1NT SEMI-FORCING

1NT

1NT = 5-11 points, the opener **MUST** rebid



The opener invents a minor even with only 3 cards!

4 SUPPORT AT 2

2 ♥

Too strong for barrage at 3, too weak for 2NT Truscott



Too balanced for barrage: use **support at 2**

6 WITH OPPONENT'S INTERVENTION →



2NT Truscott becomes **UNLIMITED** (11+ points)!



The intervention changes the meanings



SUIT LEGEND

- ♠ Spades
- ♥ Hearts
- ♦ Diamonds
- ♣ Clubs

SUMMARY CHART

0-7	+	fit 4	=	3 in the major (barrage)
0-7	+	fit 5	=	4 in the major (barrage)
8-9			=	support at 2
10-12			=	2NT Truscott



Good agreements lead to great results! ★

LESSON 210: FIT HANDS IN THE MAJOR – BERGEN AND NON-FORCING

1. TITLE: "BERGEN System: More Precise Supports!"

BERGEN RAISES

3 ♣
CLUBS

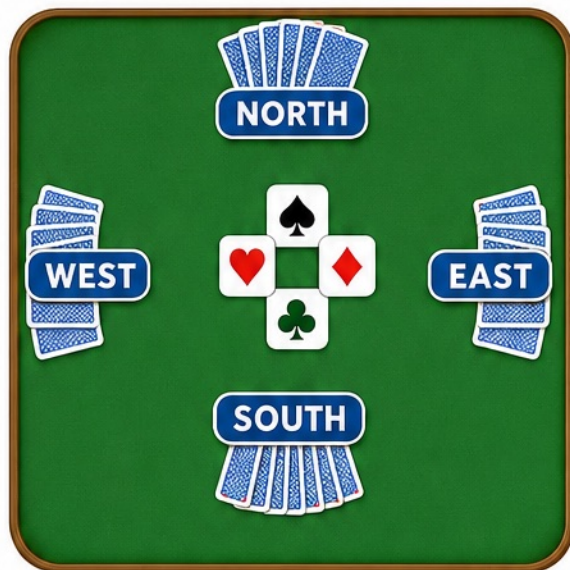
= **FOURTH** fit
with 7-9 points
(weak support)

3 ♦
DIAMONDS

= **FOURTH** fit
with 10-11 points
(invitational support)



Bergen uses minors to describe
the strength of the support!



2. 2NT TRUSCOTT in Bergen



2NT = FOURTH fit
+ 12+ points
(game forcing!)

Stronger than in Standard!

3. FORCING 1NT



1NT = range 5-11 points

- ➔ With 4-7: after the rebid,
RETURN to 2 in the major
- ➔ With 11: after the rebid,
RETURN to 3 (invitational)

4. SUPPORT AT 2 = CONSTRUCTIVE



Support at 2 =
7/8-10 points
(constructive,
not preemptive!)

In Bergen, support at 2
has a precise range

6. THE OPENER ON 1NT



**The opener
MUST rebid!**

Exception:
5332 with 11 points
can pass



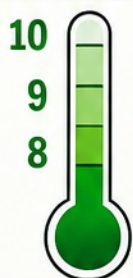
**Motto: Bergen = precision
in supports. Each level has a meaning!**



LESSON 211: FIT HANDS IN THE MAJOR – FORCING NT

1. TITLE: FORCING 1NT: THE MODERN SYSTEM FOR RAISES

2. RAISE TO 2 = CONSTRUCTIVE



- ✓ Raise to 2 = 8-10 points with **THIRD** fit
- ✓ Constructive: partner evaluates whether to go to game

3. FORCING 1NT



- Range: **5-11** points
- 2 over 1 responses = **GAME FORCING** (12+ points)
- 1NT covers the entire **weak-medium** range

4. 2NT TRUSCOTT



- ★ **FOURTH** fit + game invitation (**10-12** points)
- ★ With **THIRD** fit: use **1NT**, not **2NT**

5. WITH FIFTH FIT



2NT then raise **ANYWAY** = **10 cards in line!**

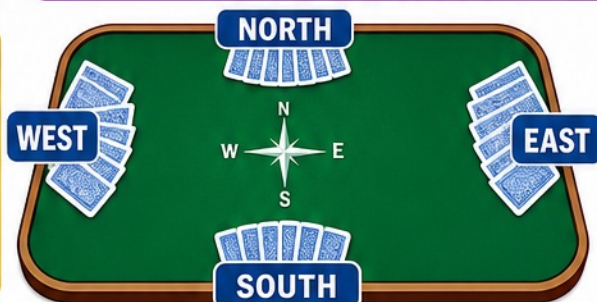
RULE: 10 cards = 10 tricks!
Go to game!

6. AFTER OPPONENT'S INTERVENTION



- ✓ Raise to 2 = entire range (**5-10** points)

The intervention simplifies:
precision is no longer needed

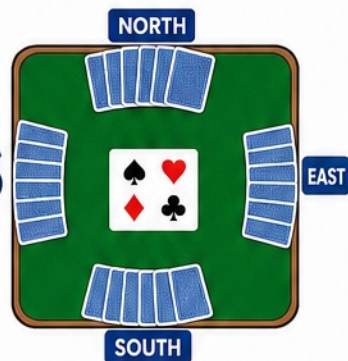


7. COMPARATIVE SUMMARY

FIT	POINT RANGE	BID	MEANING
3 ♠ ♥ ♦ ♣	8-10 points	RAISE TO 2	Constructive with third fit. Partner decides about game.
4 ♠ ♥ ♦ ♣	10-12 points	2NT TRUSCOTT	Fourth fit + game invitation. With third fit: use 1NT .
5 ♠ ♥ ♦ ♣	10+ points	2NT THEN RAISE	2NT then raise ANYWAY = 10 cards in line! Go to game!
ANY ♠ ♥ ♦ ♣	5-11 points	FORCING 1NT	Covers the entire weak-medium range.



LESSON 212: SPECIAL INTERVENTIONS AND DEFENSES



1. TITLE: "INTERVENTION CONVENTIONS: TWO-SUITED AND DEFENSES"

2. MICHAEL'S CUE BID

➔ Cue bid after opponent's
1C or 1S =
OTHER MAJOR + a MINOR

➔ Example: (1H) – 2H =
Spades + a minor
(at least 5-5!)



**At least 5-5 cards
in the two suits!**

3. GHESTEM

**STRONG 5-5 TWO-SUITED AFTER
OPPONENT'S SUIT OPENING**

MANDATORY SCHEME

2NT	= the TWO LOWER SUITS (lowest among the unbid)
3C (or lowest level 3 cue-bid)	= the TWO EXTREME SUITS (highest + lowest)
Cue-bid in opponent's suit	= the TWO INTERMEDIATE SUITS

EXAMPLE ON (1S) OPPONENT'S OPENING:

- 2NT = C+D (the two minors, lower)
- 3C = H+C (extremes: highest H + lowest C)
- 2S (cue-bid) = H+D (intermediates)

4. DEFENSE AGAINST OPPONENT'S 1NT

➔ **2C** Landy = 5/4+
in the **MAJORS**
(hearts + spades) 

➔ **2D / 2H**
= **TRANSFER**
(as after partner's 1NT) 

➔ **2NT** = the two **MINORS**
(clubs + diamonds) 

5. DEFENSE AGAINST 2D MULTICOLOR



Double =
I have HEARTS
(direct) 



Pass then Double =
I have SPADES
(delayed) 

6. FUNDAMENTAL RULE



NEVER pass off
5-4 as two-suited!

Two-suited requires
AT LEAST 5-5 cards!

MOTTO



**Conventions are
powerful tools but
require agreement
with partner!**

Lesson 213:

Special Cases after 1 over 1 Responses



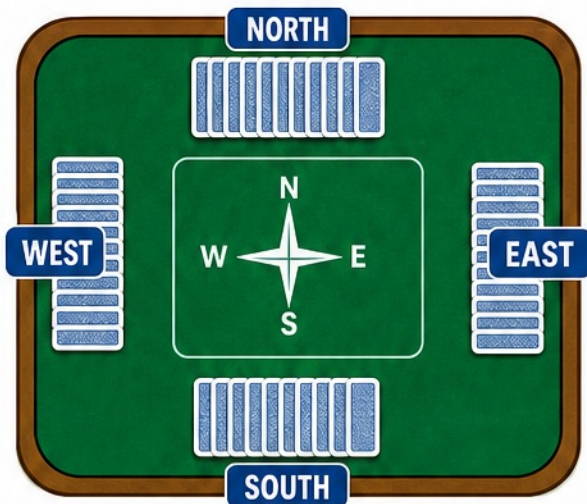
After 1 over 1: Reverse, Free Bids, and Special Cases

1. NO TRUMP REVERSE

Bid	Meaning	Distribution
2NT	17-18 points	5332 distribution
3NT	19-20 points	5332 distribution



Balanced Reverse:
Show the precise strength!



2. FREE BIDS AFTER INTERVENTION



- **Free** = after the opponent has spoken
- Make a free bid **ONLY** with something special!
- If nothing special: **PASS** (partner will speak)

3. IMMEDIATE FREE SUPPORT



- Free support = guarantees **FOURTH** fit!
- Without intervention could be third fit, with intervention = **always fourth**

4. FREE CUE BID



- The **FREE CUE BID** = the **STRONGEST** way to communicate fit!
- Bidding the opponent's suit = **strength** + **fit** in partner's suit

5. FREE DOUBLE



- Free double = **8+** points, response value (**NOT 16-20!**)
- Indicates **4** cards in each unbid suit
- Replaces the 1 over 1 response when the opponent has interfered



MOTTO:

After the intervention,
bids become more precise:
free = **special!**

